TEACHER GUIDE

WJEC GCSE Business (C00/4967/2)

# Production and capacity

Unit 3: Business Strategies for Success
**3.6 Methods of production · 3.6.1 Production**



A revision lesson. Pupils run a car dealership in firms of four and revise production and capacity on their own deals. Seat each firm together. Each firm answers the topic tasks together.

## The lesson

**45-minute setting**

| Setup | Round 1 | Round 2 | Round 3 | Final questions |
|---|---|---|---|---|

### EVERY ROUND

**Firm decisions**
3 min

→

**Deals**
4½–5 min

→

**Topic tasks**
4 min

→

**B2B deal**
2½ min
from Round 2

### LESSON SETTINGS

| 30 min | 45 min | 60 min | 75 min |
|---|---|---|---|

# What pupils do

Every pupil buys and sells cars. In Firm decisions, each role has its own job.



## CEO

**Staff · Sabotage** from Round 2



## Finance

**Capital & Loans · Investments**



## Sales & Marketing

**Marketing**



## Operations

**Seasonal stock**

# Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same.

## 1 Cars per staff

Round 1

The prep workshop.

**Cars prepared per member of staff a day?**

| | |
|---|---|
| Cars prepared a week | **60 cars** |
| Staff | **6 staff** |
| Days worked a week | **5 days** |

**ANSWER**

**£2**

60 ÷ 6 = 10 a week; ÷ 5 = 2 cars

**Why:** Productivity is output for each worker in a set time.

## 2 Raise output

Round 1

Your prep workshop is slow.

**Which two would raise output per worker?**

- **A** Buy better equipment
- **B** Raise your prices
- **C** Train staff in faster methods
- **D** Cut the hours staff work
- **E** Hire more staff with the same tools

**ANSWER**

**✓ Buy better equipment**
**✓ Train staff in faster methods**

**Why:** Productivity is output per worker; more staff raise output, not productivity.

## 3 Rank productivity

Round 2

Three workshops: cars prepared a week, and the staff who prepare them.

**Order by productivity, highest first?**

- **A** 24 cars, 4 staff
- **B** 45 cars, 15 staff
- **C** 40 cars, 8 staff

**ANSWER**

**1. 24 cars, 4 staff**
**2. 40 cars, 8 staff**
**3. 45 cars, 15 staff**

**Why:** Cars per worker: 6, 5 and 3. The busiest workshop is the least productive.

# Topic tasks

## 4 New productivity

Round 2

More staff, more cars.

**New cars prepared per member of staff?**

| | |
|---|---|
| Cars prepared a week | **28 cars** |
| Staff | **4 staff** |
| Extra staff | **3 staff** |
| Extra cars prepared a week | **28 cars** |

**ANSWER**

**8 cars**

(28 + 28) ÷ (4 + 3) = 8 cars

**Why:** Productivity rose from 7 to 8 cars per worker.

## 5 One-off big order

Round 3

Your workshop is fully booked. A one-off big order arrives.

**How should you handle it, and why?**

**A** Pay overtime for this order

**B** Build a new prep bay

**ANSWER**

**✔ Pay overtime for this order**

**Why:** A one-off order does not justify the cost of a new bay.

## 6 Productivity rise %

Round 3

New tools and training.

**Rise in cars per worker, as a %?**

| | |
|---|---|
| Cars a week, before | **16 cars** |
| Staff, before | **4 staff** |
| Cars a week, after | **18 cars** |
| Staff, after | **3 staff** |

**ANSWER**

**50%**

16 ÷ 4 = 4; 18 ÷ 3 = 6; (6 − 4) ÷ 4 × 100 = 50%

**Why:** Each worker now prepares 6 cars a week, not 4.

# Final questions

Each pupil answers 6 final questions on production and capacity. They come from these 8 questions.

1 Which situation is best suited to job production?
✔ **Restoring one classic car to a customer's wishes**

2 What is a likely advantage of flow production for standardised components?
✔ **High volumes at a low cost per unit**

3 A workshop queues every Saturday but has spare weekday capacity. What should it do before paying for a permanent extra bay?
✔ **First test moving work to weekdays**

4 A viral review causes a sudden rise in service bookings. What is the best short-term response?
✔ **Prioritise bookings and add trained help**

5 A workshop converts one van at a time to each customer's own design. Which production method is this?
✔ **Job production**

6 A parts maker produces thousands of identical brake pads on a continuous line. What is a main advantage of this flow production?
✔ **Low cost per unit from high volume**

7 A body shop paints each car in the exact colour and design the customer asks for. Which method of production is this?
✔ **Job production**

8 A workshop has 4 mechanics. Together they service 96 cars in a week. What is the labour productivity per mechanic?
✔ **24 cars a week**